



Tennis Premier League: Bengaluru Mavericks triumphs

The mixed doubles pair of Vishnu Vardhan and Arina Rodionova defeated Maria Timofeeva and Anirudh Chandrasekar 14-6 helping Bengaluru SG Mavericks to a 41-28 victory over Bengal Wizards in the final of the fifth edition of Tennis Premier League on the charcoal grey courts of the Shiv Chhatrapati Sports Complex.

The teams were level after the two singles matches, won by Timofeeva against Arina and Ramkumar Ramanathan against Sriram Balaji at 20-20. Arina rose to the challenge in the mixed doubles match which witnessed many arguments and disputed calls. Arina and Vishnu were able to stay focused and take the match away from the Bengal team.

Thereafter, it was a simple task of winning seven points in the men's doubles match. Ramkumar and Vishnu cruised to a 7-2 win over Sriram Balaji and Anirudh who had done remarkably well to take the team this far.

It was celebration time for the Bengaluru team with coach M Balachandran as mentor. The team was truly dominant right through after the 39-41 loss to Punjab Patriots in the first match.

For her energetic performance in the final, Arina Rodionova was declared the 'player of the match.'

Kamesh Srinivasan

SPORTOON



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Chennai's Sandeep Kumar and Bengaluru youngster Chetan Surnineni won the titles

in the showpiece MRF Formula 2000 and 1600 categories, respectively, of the MRF MMSC fm sci Indian National Car Racing Championship 2023 at the Madras International Circuit. Also picking up the National titles in their respective categories were Gurunath Meiyappan (Race Concepts, Indian Touring Cars), Deepak Ravikumar (Performance Racing, Indian Junior Touring Cars) and Diljith TS (DTS Racing, Super Stock and Formula LGB 1300).

The Championship battle in the MRF Formula 2000 went right down to the wire. Sandeep Kumar did just enough to pick up crucial points and pip Kolkata's Arya Singh by just three points to claim the championship. Incidentally, both the MRF F2000 races were won by Bengaluru's Aditya Swaminathan.

Another Chennai driver, Deepak Ravikumar edged out his Performance Racing team-mate Akkineni Anand Prasad for the title in the IJTC class by winning both the races today for a double while 30-year-old Diljith, who had effectively sealed the championship with a round to spare, only confirmed the title in the Super Stock category.

Team Sportstar